**New Dundee Public School - School Council Agenda/Minutes**

**Date:** May 1, 2025
**Time:** 7:00 p.m. – 8:20 p.m.

**Meeting Link:** **link**
**School Council Handbook:** School Council Handbook

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**1. Introductions and Attendance**

- **Principal:** Craig Bell
- **Staff:** Kelly Willig,
- **Chair:** Angie Hallman
- **Co-Chair:** Sarah Cherry
- **Secretary:** Melissa Kristensen
- **Treasurer:** Sarah Benn

- **School Council:** Keizo Marui,
- **Student:** none
- **Regrets:** Kathy Walus, Steph Britkropf, Paula Wilson

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**2. Welcome / Territory Acknowledgment**

As we gather virtually this evening, we would like to honor the existence of the First Peoples by acknowledging that we are on the traditional land of the Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and Mississauga peoples. New Dundee Public School occupies the land of the Between the Lakes Treaty from 1792. As learners, we continue to understand this place has significance to the First Peoples because of the rolling hills, forests, flat land, and the proximity to the Nith and Grand River, which is fed by the Great Lakes. Settlers need to take responsibility to continue our education and honor of the First Peoples. Let's work to honor the Dish with One Spoon covenant, a peace agreement made between the Indigenous nations before the settlers arrived. It characterizes our collective responsibility to each other and to Mother Earth. We should only take what we need and leave enough for future generations.

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1. **Drills, Safety etc.**

- **Asbestos update -** Response from an Environmental Officer at WRDSB:
- *Asbestos is a fibrous mineral that was used extensively in Ontario from about 1900 until the 1980's in the manufacture of construction and industrial products, mostly due to its characteristics of strength, heat resistance and chemical resistance. Asbestos Containing Materials (ACM) were also commonly used in building materials such as pipe and boiler insulation, texture finishes, floor and ceiling tiles, and spray applied for fireproofing and thermal insulation.*

- ***Asbestos fibres are a concern when they become airborne as a result of disturbance or deterioration.*** *It is acknowledged that all ACM do not have to be removed or replaced to ensure a safe working environment, but proper control measures and procedures are required to prevent the disturbance of ACM and to protect maintenance staff and building occupants from exposure to harmful levels of airborne asbestos.*

- ***Under Ontario Regulation 278/05, the WRDSB is required to provide documentation pertaining to ACM within its buildings.***
- *A consultant had inspected / surveyed each school and provided an Asbestos Audit Report identifying the type and locations of known and suspected ACM. The inspections were performed with good intent and purpose to determine the location and condition of ACM. These inspections were non-invasive, whereby ACM that may be visually concealed by, but not necessarily limited to ceilings, walls, bulkheads, floors, roofs, vertical chases, trenches, crawl spaces, shafts, tunnels and other similar structures was not identified. However, ACM that could be present in these locations may become apparent during future construction, renovation, demolition, and/or maintenance activities.*

- *Annually, a consultant is inspecting / surveying each school to re-assess and document the condition of identified ACM present within the building and make appropriate recommendations for management, abatement or remedial activities, as required.*

- ***An Asbestos Binder is located in the Main Office of each school, in a visible and accessible location. The following documents are in the binder:***
- *-Asbestos Audit Update Report - completed every few years, after renovations / additions*

- *-Asbestos Inspection - completed every year;*
- *-Confirmation of Asbestos Removal Letter(s) - ACM was removed from a location due to recommendation from an inspection or school improvement*
- *-Lab Results for Additional Sampling*

- ***During the last few years, the Board has removed a large quantity of ACM (floors, pipe insulation and fittings) at New Dundee PS, but there are still some identified and will be removed during renovations (windows and doors sealant, pipe insulation and fittings in concealed locations).***

- ***The other important thing to note is during our ACM audits, one of the main components is the condition of the ACM. If there is any sign of deterioration, it is removed by certified Asbestos removal contractors right away.***

- **Action Items:**

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**2. Staffing Update**

- We are thrilled that Ms. McGill has returned to 1/2A! We are so thankful for Ms. Rohacek for teaching this class while Ms. McGill was away. Ms Rohacek received a small gift as a 'thank-you'.
- The WRDSB Staffing Process for the 2025-2026 school year is well under way. Over the coming weeks and months, I will be working with our educators to determine class assignments and class building for next year.
  Parents/caregivers are reminded that teacher and student assignments are tentative (can always change). We are a small school so there's not a lot of flexibility when it comes to placement. Please note that streaming students is not something that we do anymore either.

- **Action Items:**

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**3. Clubs**

- -**Kodaly Music club** -weekly singing sessions for Junior students
- -**Taming the Dragon (Porchlight - Community Partner)** - Weekly sessions in April and May with Ms. De Naeyer's (1/2B) and Ms. McGill's (1/2A) classes to educate about how to manage anxiety, expressing emotions in a healthy way, helpful thought patterns, compassion and being a friend.
- -**ESQube** - STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering & Mathematics) - students from the University of Waterloo facilitate sessions for 2/3A, 3/4A, 4/5A & 5/6A

**Action Items:**

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**4. Assemblies:**

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- **Action Items:**

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**5. Events, Field Trips & Initiatives**

**<u>Field Trips</u>**

-**April 10th** - **Kodaly** field trip; Concert May 7th at the "Centre in the Square"
-**May 3rd** - **Ball-Stars Basketball Tournament** - Mr. Heer is accompanying some junior students to Wilfrid Laurier University on Saturday, May 3rd for a friendly basketball tournament focussed on team building and engagement
-**May 12th** - Grade 5/6 Field Trip to **Blair Road Outdoor Centre**
-**May 13th** - Rooms 1, 2, & 9 are going on a field trip to **Five Oaks Centre** in Paris, ON "to explore biodiversity, diversity, and inclusion through the lens of the natural world"
-Kindergarten trips coming up
-Buses costs are rising, ~$225 plus tax per trip. Teachers appreciate relying on 1-2 field trips per year.

**Events & Initiatives**

**-Dental Screening** - Thursday, May 1st for Kindergarten & Grade 2 students
**-Jump Rope for Heart** - Kick-off assembly was held on March 28th, Friday, April 25th finale with special guests, weekly "JR4H Gotchas" and prizes
**-"Welcome to School" (formerly, "Welcome to Kindergarten") Night** - Thursday, May 29th at 6:00 PM - School Council members are invited to set up a station

- Good number of kids enrolling in September

**-Dragon Run** - Wednesday, May 14th.

- Annette buys freezes and Kelly stores them and brings them to the run.

**-Track and Field** - New Dundee event on Tuesday, June 3rd; Regional Track event on Monday, June 16th
-**ESQube** (STEM - Science, Technology, Engineering & Mathematics) sessions with specific classes will occur in April/May.
-**EQAO:** Grade 3 testing dates - **May 26-29** (Ms. Bricker & Ms. Wilson); Grade 6 testing dates - **May 20-23** (Mr. McKenzie)

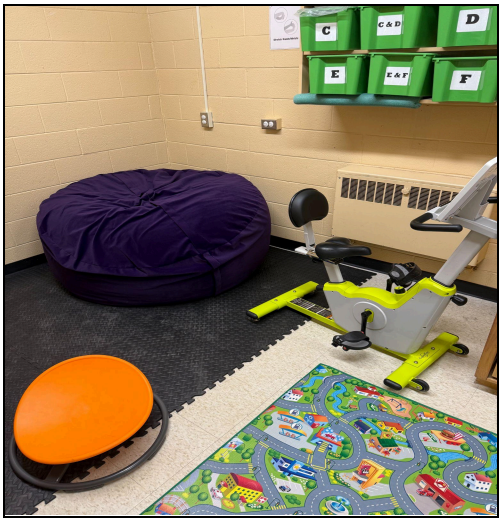
- All online now, practice tests available

- **Action Items:**
  - Welcome to school, kindergarteners volunteers - Melissa, Sarah C? Send out email for volunteers again
  - Fruit supplied to classes for EQAO - send email out to the community (watermelon, oranges)

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**6. School Improvements**

- Have purchased new high jump mat and bar, ordered new tables for the library/learning commons, ordered (and now have) new carpets for boots/shoes in the hallway; blinds for classrooms to come (still working with the Facilities Department). Funded by school budget and facilities, not council funds.
- **Sensory Room** - Craig to explain the purpose of supportive, alternative spaces for students such as "sensory rooms".

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- Pictures are of sensory section of literacy room. Equipment an occupational therapist has assessed and assigned to specific kids in our school. E.g. bean bag can apply pressure and help childern that need a squeeze for support.
- School council cant purchase material, only OT can prescribe materials.
- Parent has to consent to the referral to the OT and is involved in the process.

- **Action Items:**

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**7. Volunteers Update**

- New Dundee Volunteer package - Police Check and volunteer package required in order to volunteer.  Contact the office for forms or more information

- **Action Items:**

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**8.  Principal Fundraising Update**

- $1501.93 was raised from the Scholastic Book Fair back in the Fall of 2024. With the help of Mrs. Seibert, our Library Clerk, we ordered a variety of resources for teachers and students totaling $1501.
- Fidget items for classroom, headphones, some books, etc. Staff worked with Rebecca and picked out what they wanted and classrooms got what they needed.

- **Action Items:**

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**9. Gardens**

- Spring Garden clean up, we really need lots of hands for this. Possibility of highschool students for volunteer hours
- **Kelly/Sarah C to comment on action item:** Kelly W will ask her Nephew. Sarah C to get a school day message ready to ask for student volunteers to do it and ask for parents to help while they wait to pick up kids at the end of the day
    - Kelly's nephew will volunteer
- **Craig / Paula give a butterfly waystation update**
    - Firm date not provided on signage
- Ms. Mesar is focusing on gardening bins on the side of the school, and will join in a future school council meeting.
- Contact Mr. Kongdara about filling out water reservoir in the summer
- Sarah is going to bring plants to fill the empty planters
- **Action Items:**
    - Can we get compost soil for garden bins? Can get it for free at the dump.
    - Sarah C to get a school day message ready to ask for student volunteers to do it and ask for parents to help while they wait to pick up kids at the end of the day
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**10. Grade six transition planning**

- **Friday, May 2nd** - Ms. Ferreira, Mr. McKenzie and Mr. Bell to meet with Sir Adam Beck PS staff for initial transition meetings.

- **Tuesday, May 27th** - 11:00 AM - 1:00 PM - NDD Grade 6s visit Sir Adam Beck PS for games, lunch and interactive activities with their Grade 6s.

- **Thursday, June 5th** (morning) - Mr. Sparks (Principal at SAB) and Ms. Kang (Special Education Resource Teacher) visiting New Dundee PS to facilitate a Q&A for our Grade 6 students.

- **Wednesday, June 11th** - Sir Adam Beck PS Open House for the families of all prospective Grade 7 students from 6:00-7:00 PM. Intermediate educators will be on-hand to meet-and-greet, and support.

- **Grade 6 Celebration**
    - Our annual Grade 6 Celebration is scheduled for the evening of **Thursday, June 19th** from **6:45-7:45 PM** in our gymnasium. More details to come. This date was vetted through Sir Adam Beck PS so there won't be a scheduling conflict.

- **Action Items:**

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**11. PD Days and Breaks**

- Next PD Day is May 30th - more information to come

- **Action Items:**

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**12. Nutrition for Learning**

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- **Action Items:**

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**13. Strong Start (Kelly)**

- Update from **Kelly,** comment on action item: Add to agenda for June. Prepare to start this in the Fall to get two rounds in per year to get more students access to program.

- **Action Items:**

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**14. Playground Structure Update**

- Facilities makes the decision when children can start playing on the equipment
- Sand assessment will happen next week, earliest to open is May 15; Safety issue when there isn't enough sand

- **Action Items:** Discussion on how much money do we set aside for repairs or replacements a year?

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**15. Class Shuffling Update**

- Skip for this meeting.

- **Action Items:**

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**16. Educators Wish List**

**Action Items:**

**17. Financial Report**

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| **School Council Funds Summary** | | |
| **April 2025** | | |
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| *Main Account* | | |
| Opening balance - September 2024 | 2,197.46 | |
| Herrle's fundraiser (net raised) | 772.07 | |
| Baden Coffee Fundraiser (net raised) | 496.30 | |
| Mabel's Labels Fundraiser (net raised) | 50.90 | |
| Rheo Thompson Fundraiser (net raised) | 1,380.59 | |
| | | |
| Scholastic deposit fee | -98.45 | |
| Drum repair | -200.00 | |
| Bus for field trip | -203.81 | |
| Xylophone repair | -96.01 | |
| Other | 119.01 | |
| **Balance in account at April XXX, 2025** | **4,418.06** | |
| | | |
| *WEFI Account* | | |
| Specialty Recess Equipment | -551.33 | (approved previous year) |
| Nutrition for Learning donation | -1,000.00 | (approved previous year) |
| Gym Equipment | -1052.41 | |
| Dance-a-thon WEFI donations | 2,080.03 | |
| Misc donations | 490.62 | |
| | | |

- Rheo Thompason $4,069 received, $2,843.15 cost, $118.00 deposit fee, $272.74 tax rebate
- Other will be explained later this month when Sarah B is back
- Dance-a-thon additional $670.29 deposits since last meeting

**Parent Involvement Funding Grant ($500)**

For projects that demonstrate inclusion/outreach to school communities. Examples of expenditures that demonstrate parent engagement, inclusion, equity and/or outreach to school communities may include:

- support of the School Improvement Plan;
- costs related to parent engagement activities in your school;
- translation of posters/literature;
- purchase of parenting books or videos to loan to parents;
- engagement initiatives that support optimizing student learning and achievement;
- meeting costs including honoraria for guest presenters;
- costs related to parent information/orientation sessions;
- costs incurred for workshops supporting student learning and achievement;
- costs related to the development and maintenance of the school websites;
- initiatives that assist special community populations facing access/involvement barriers.

$500 deposited directly into our account and we have to use it otherwise we will lose it.

***We are unable to apply this amount to the year-end staff luncheon**

- **Funds Voted to Spend:**
- **Pro Grant -** for the community - June 7th, registration is full! 30 participants
- $140.80 **in the School Council Float**

**Action item:**

- Start organizing teacher appreciation day - Angie

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**18. Fundraising Plan for 2024/2025 (Angie/Sarah C)**

- **Veggie Boxes:** September (Sarah C Update)
  - Sold 129, earning $903
  - Next year, count the boxes as we take them
- **Bookfair**: November
  - Scholastic points are used to purchase items for the school, determined by the staff
  - Went smoothly with kids having a look the day before
  - Some parents said their children did not get the correct change, it is a fast paced environment. We try to encourage parents to send exact change.

Children sometimes would share with their friends, lose their money, or go back for bookmarks.

- **Coffee:** December
    - Order due date is November 14
    - Gave them our drink selection (regular coffee, vanilla hazelnut, decaf coffee, peppermint tea, and hot chocolate)
    - Give orders to kids directly instead of parent pick-up
- **Dance-A-Thon:** Friday February 14
    - Scott helps with the equipment
    - NDPS alumni that are in highschool come help
    - Each group of kids came down for 30 minutes blocks during the middle block of the day, 12pm-2pm
    - Each child will be given a glow stick from last year's leftover supply and there will be no additional items for sale.
    - Kids can fundraise online or bring in cash the day of the dance-a-thon.
    - Discussion about wording on dance-a-thon form about online donations
    - Volunteers - Kelly, Angie, Sarah C.
- **Chocolate Sales:** March, came back before Easter
- **Garden Centre:** April/May, using a gift card from Colour Paradise. - CANCELLED

**Action Items:**

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**19. WRAPSC/PIC Meeting Update (Angie)**

- Meeting coming up - goal setting for next year

**Action Items:**

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**20. Items Added by Council Members**

- voting and non voting members by law to the agenda this month.
- Engaged and non-engaged members voting on fundraiser or other council decision

- If you are going to vote then you must participate more fully - how to define this? Ask member if they want to vote, then here is the criteria.
- **Action Items:**
    - There is a sample on-line to create wording for voting members
    - Next meeting discuss hot lunch - review results, and plan for next year. What are the other options?

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**21. 2024 / 2025 School Council Dates**

- September 16th
- October 21st (7 p.m. - Election/Roles Vote)
- November 25th
- January 27th
- February 24th
- April 21st
- May 26th

- **Action Items:**
- Please email Craig and Angie with any questions and your intent to fill/run for a position on school council. ahallmanrmt@gmail.com and craig_bell@wrdsb.ca
- Here is a link to the handbook School Council Handbook it contains the description of each role.

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**23. Care Committee (Kelly):**
Dedicated to supporting the well-being of members through acts of kindness, empathy, and practical assistance. The committee's primary goal is to foster a compassionate environment where people feel cared for and supported during times of need, whether due to celebrations or personal challenges. Coordinating gestures: Sending cards, flowers, or small gifts to show care and support during life events and calendar celebrations. Collecting donations from the community is part of this role as it can not be covered by school council funds.

- Sent to church for NFL
- Principal day
- Sarah B for her new baby
- Volunteer week - coming next week; appreciation day
- Administrative day, last week

- Secretary day May 16

**Action Items:**

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**24. Meeting Minutes**

- Consents by attendees that the minutes reflect the meeting

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**25. Agenda Items for next meeting:**
Please email the chair or administration with any agenda requests before the next meeting: ndpscouncil@gmail.com & craig_bell@wrdsb.ca